



Warehouse questions and back-order resolution.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how the Customer Success team handles warehouse questions, back orders, customer communication, refunds, draft orders, and email procedures. It standardizes decisions made when items are discontinued or out of stock, so shipments leave the warehouse the same day and customers are informed in their preferred language.

2. Scope

Applies to every member of the Customer Success team handling DSS Distro and FLVR SHOT (Flavor Shot) orders. Covers Microsoft Teams monitoring, warehouse question resolution, customer outreach, refunds, draft orders, sample swaps, and email standards. Pricing approvals, credit-limit changes, and wholesale account onboarding are out of scope and handled under separate SOPs.

3. Communication channels

Microsoft Teams is the main communication platform. Warehouse questions are posted on the dedicated “Warehouse Questions” channel. Other channels used daily include Missed Opportunities, General, Sales Meeting, and SOPs and Policies. The warehouse questions channel must be monitored continuously — urgent shipping decisions are often required within minutes.

CHANNEL	PURPOSE	MONITORING
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Warehouse questions	Discontinued / out-of-stock items, swaps, holds.	Continuous, priority.
Missed opportunities	Quoted orders not converted; recovery actions.	Daily review.
General	Company-wide announcements and updates.	Daily review.
Sales meeting	Pre-read and outcomes for sales sync.	As scheduled.
SOPs and policies	Process updates and reference material.	On change.
Cancelled orders	Internal notes confirming refunds completed.	On refund.

4. Warehouse question workflow

Warehouse staff post questions when an order contains a discontinued or out-of-stock item. Each question must be resolved before 3:00 PM whenever possible so changes can be processed and shipped the same day.

1. Open the warehouse questions Teams channel and read the post in full. Note the order reference, customer name, item, and quantity.
2. Review the customer's order history before deciding. Confirm whether the customer already has another back order so shipments can be combined.
3. Determine the cause: **discontinued** (item will not return to stock) or **out of stock** (temporary, expected to return).
4. Contact the customer. Offer replacement (swap) options when an item is discontinued; offer to hold or split-ship when the item is temporarily out of stock.
5. Post the customer decision back to the warehouse questions channel with the order reference, the action taken, and any refund or credit applied.
6. If the response cannot be obtained before 3:00 PM, post a follow-up note to the warehouse channel so the warehouse team can hold or split-ship the order accordingly.

Posts on the warehouse questions channel follow a standard format: order reference, customer name, item, quantity affected, and a short note. Figure 1 shows a canonical example.



Figure 1 — Example warehouse question on the Teams channel: Sweet Pineapple back order, customer accepts a swap to Hawaiian mix, balance refunded.

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Refunding the full back-ordered quantity before checking order history. If the customer already has another open back order, combining shipments and partial swaps usually keeps the customer whole — a blind refund costs a sale that could have been saved.

5. Customer communication standards

Communicate clearly and professionally on every customer interaction. Every outbound message includes order number, product name, and the specific reason for the issue. When a product is discontinued, state plainly that it will not return to stock and offer alternatives where available.

- Use French for Quebec customers and English for customers outside Quebec.
- Reference the order number in every message — never a vague “your order”.
- Lead with the action being taken (swap, refund, hold) before the explanation.
- Offer at least one alternative when an item is discontinued and a comparable SKU exists.

6. Refund procedures

Refunds follow the original payment method whenever possible.

- **Credit card** — process the refund directly to the original card. (SOP-CS-001)
- **E-transfer** — issue the refund as a customer account credit instead of attempting an outbound transfer. (SOP-CS-009)
- Notify the customer by email once the refund is processed.
- Add an internal note confirming the refund in the Cancelled Orders Teams channel.

7. Samples and product swaps

Free samples do not always require customer approval for substitutions. Warehouse managers may decide sample replacements internally. All swaps — sample or paid — are documented on the warehouse questions Teams channel with the order reference and the SKUs swapped.

8. FLVR SHOT (Flavor Shot) procedures

Flavor Shot orders use a separate brand identity, email address, and ordering rules. The team must distinguish Flavor Shot orders from DSS Distro orders on every interaction.

- **Flavor Shot** wholesale customers must order full boxes, not individual units.
- Only end consumers may order individual bottles.
- Use the official Flavor Shot email address for all Flavor Shot communications.
- Document discontinued Flavor Shot items carefully — some customers may still have old back orders against them.
- Keep communication standardized for consistency across the Flavor Shot customer base.

9. Email best practices

Use templates whenever possible to save time and keep tone consistent. Every customer email is professional, clear, and concise.

- Always include the order reference number in the subject line and body.
- Send from the correct company email address — DSS Distro for DSS orders, Flavor Shot for Flavor Shot orders.
- Mark messages as high importance only when an urgent decision is required.

10. Example customer email (French)

Standard French refund-notification template for Quebec customers. Replace customer name, item, and payment method as needed; keep the wording consistent.

Modèle — remboursement Flavor Shot

Bonjour Sébastien,

Nous souhaitons vous informer que nous avons procédé au remboursement de l'item figurant dans votre commande puisque cette saveur a été discontinuée. Afin de ne pas retarder votre commande d'aujourd'hui, le remboursement a été effectué directement sur votre carte Visa.

Merci et bonne journée,

L'équipe Flavor Shot

11. Daily priorities

1. Check warehouse questions Teams channel first thing in the morning and after each break.
2. Handle urgent shipping decisions before 3:00 PM so the warehouse can process same-day.
3. Follow up on open back orders and discontinued items — verify whether stock has returned or alternatives are available.
4. Update customers proactively when their order status changes — do not wait for the customer to chase.
5. Verify stock in Shopify/Production file before confirming any new order or replacement SKU.
6. Document every customer interaction in Act — swaps, refunds, holds, and language preferences.

Non-Compliance

Warehouse questions left unanswered past 3:00 PM force the warehouse to hold the affected order to the next business day, which delays the entire customer order and triggers re-pick labour. Refunds processed without an internal note in the Cancelled Orders channel create accounting reconciliation gaps at month-end. Sending DSS Distro communications from the Flavor Shot email address (or vice versa) confuses customers and violates brand separation. Repeated non-compliance is escalated to the Customer Success Lead and reflected in the next performance review.

Exceptions

The Customer Success Lead may approve deviations — for example, refunding an e-transfer payment back as an outbound transfer for a top-tier wholesale account, or holding a warehouse decision past 3:00 PM when the customer is unreachable and the order is non-urgent. Every approved exception is logged in the Cancelled Orders or warehouse questions Teams channel with the approver's name and the reason. Exceptions are reviewed monthly to identify recurring patterns that may warrant a permanent SOP update.